

Project XTC – Development Edition 0.1

Chapter 8 – Motor Faders: When the Controller Comes Alive

Motor faders are one of the defining features of the X-Touch. Unlike ordinary MIDI controllers, the faders do not simply send information to Bitwig—they also respond to it. Open a project, switch banks or play back automation and the faders move automatically to reflect Bitwig's current state.

Bitwig Is the Source of Truth

The physical position of a motor fader is never an independent record of your mix. Instead, Bitwig continuously tells the X-Touch where each fader should be. If you load a different project, the faders immediately move to match that project's mixer settings.

Touch-Sensitive Control

Each motor fader can detect when you place a finger on it. This is important during automation recording because Bitwig can distinguish between a fader moving under motor power and a fader that you intend to control manually.

Working with Automation

Record a simple volume automation pass, then play it back. Watch the fader follow every movement you recorded. The moving fader becomes a visual representation of your mix, making it easy to understand exactly what the automation is doing.

Good Working Habits

- Let a motorised fader finish moving before taking control.
- Avoid forcing a moving fader against the motor.
- During playback, watch the faders as well as listening—they often reveal automation changes before you hear them.

Field Note #010

If all of the motor faders suddenly stop responding, first verify that the X-Touch is still in MCU mode and that the correct X-Touch INT ports are selected in DrivenByMoss. Connection problems are far more common than hardware faults.

Exercise

Create two tracks with different volume automation. Play the project several times while watching the motor faders. Then touch a fader during playback and observe how Bitwig hands control to you without losing synchronisation.

Key Takeaways

- Motor faders both send and receive information.
- Bitwig always determines the correct fader position.
- Touch sensitivity is essential for smooth automation recording.
- Moving faders are a useful source of visual feedback.

Before You Continue...

Part I is now complete. You understand the core ideas behind the X-Touch: focus, modes, banks, feedback and motorised control. In Part II we begin applying those ideas to Bitwig, starting with installation, configuration and day-to-day operation.